

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

REAL0.18

CONS.0.19

COMM.0.37

INDUS0.49

UTILI0.51

HEALT0.58

CONS.1.35

MATER2.97

FINAN3.02

ENERG3.45

TECHN31.21

1

AMZN

BUY

\$277.51

+0.03%

8/10

The AI re-acceleration plus AI infrastructure buildout make Amazon a core

2

MU

BUY

\$898.58

+0.66%

8/10

The AI buildout is creating a memory chip shortage, and Micron is one

3

NVDA

BUY

\$219.99

+3.80%

8/10

The AI infrastructure buildout is a multi-year government-and-hypersca

Big options bets on AMD (Technology) — 23.7x normal volume, P/C 0.59, largest: C ALL \$335 (34.0x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP

No major earnings this week

FED & ECONOMY TODAY

Nonfarm Payrolls

Date: 2026-08-05

HIGH

VIX at 16.9 — low. Options market complacent ahead of scheduled events.

Nonfarm Payrolls [HIGH]

SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?

No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

FEELING RELAXED

Junk bonds: calm · Safe bonds: in demand · borrowing getting cheaper (calm)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Big money is piling into the classic "defensive plus rate-cut winners" playbook — Real Estate, Staples, Utilities, and Healthcare are all seeing bullish flow, which tells you institutions are positioning for the Fed to cut rates and are hiding in stuff that pays dividends and doesn't need a hot economy.

The really interesting bullish bets are in Communication Services and Industrials with massive unusual volume, and that lines up with Washington: Industrials benefit directly from continued defense spending, reshoring incentives still flowing from the CHIPS Act and IRA, and any infrastructure follow-through, while Comm Services is likely a bet that the antitrust pressure on Big Tech platforms is softening under the current administration's lighter regulatory posture.

On the other side, the bearish flow is loud and specific — Technology's put/call ratio at 31 is a screaming hedge, meaning nobody is selling their Nvidia and Microsoft, they're buying insurance against an AI-capex air pocket, tariff blowback on semis, or a China escalation; Energy and Materials getting hit suggests traders think tariffs and a slowing global economy will crush commodity demand despite the "drill baby drill" rhetoric, and Financials bearishness fits if rate cuts compress bank margins.

Historically this rotation — defensives up, cyclical and tech hedged, credit spreads tightening — precedes either a mild growth scare with a Fed rescue or a stealth topping process over the next 4-8 weeks, not a crash.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc.	8.53/100
Leidos combines defense IT modernization with AI-enabled intellig			
2.	MSFT	Microsoft Corporation	8.46/100
Microsoft remains the highest-conviction mega-cap AI play with Az			
3.	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc.	7.71/100
SMCI is the purest AI-infrastructure hardware play left in the sc			

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 9–10	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 11–12	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 13–14	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 17–18	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 19–20	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 21–22	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Buy \$307.02 ▼ 0.76% 12M Price Target \$340.00 52-Week Range \$205.59 – \$344.57 Market Cap \$4.48T

AAPL: Cook Exit Jitters Meet iPhone Supercycle Setup

WHAT HAPPENED

- Two big storylines colliding: Apple's purchase commitments jumped 28% — that's the money Apple pre-pays suppliers for parts, and it's basically a leading indicator of how many iPhones they're planning to build. BofA reads this as an iPhone ramp, meaning the new model cycle looks strong. Memory chip stocks are rallying on the same news because Apple buys their DRAM/NAND.
- Tim Cook is on his way out. That's the "departing CEO" story — and it's the reason the stock dropped from \$333 last week to \$307 now. Market hates succession uncertainty, even when the fundamentals look great.

WHY IT MATTERS

The 8% drop from the July 30 high isn't about the business — it's about Cook leaving. That's actually a setup, not a problem, because the supplier commitment data is telling you the iPhone cycle is accelerating right into the transition. Options flow backs this up: put/call ratio at 0.57 (meaning 57 puts for every 100 calls — bullish positioning) with massive unusual call buying at the \$310 strike expiring this month. Translation: smart money is betting the CEO drama fades and the fundamentals reassert. Watch for the succession announcement — if it's an internal COO type (predictable), the stock likely reclaims \$325 fast.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

China tariffs are the big overhang — the Trump admin's ongoing trade posture directly hits Apple because roughly 80% of iPhones are still assembled in China despite India diversification. Any escalation this fall could clip margins by 200-400 basis points (basically 2-4% of every revenue dollar disappears). On the flip side, the 9th Circuit browser ruling referenced today extends the App Store legal ambiguity — meaning Apple keeps collecting its 30% App Store cut while the legal framework gets sorted, which is a quiet win. Also watch the Iran deal headlines — a deal calms oil, which calms inflation, which helps consumer discretionary spending on \$1,200 phones.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

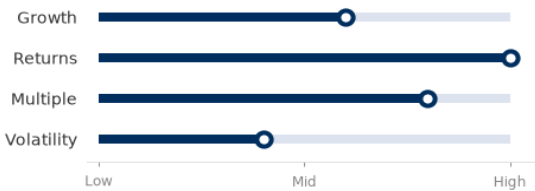
At \$307 and ~39x forward earnings, investors are paying \$39 for every \$1 of profit Apple will make next year. That's expensive versus the S&P at ~22x, but Apple has historically traded at a premium because of its cash generation and buybacks. The question isn't whether it's cheap (it isn't) — it's whether the iPhone ramp + Services growth justifies holding a \$4.5 trillion company at these multiples. Given the supplier data, I think yes, but there's not much margin for error.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$307.02
12M Price Target	\$340.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.7%
Market Cap	\$4.48T
FY2026E Revenue	\$445M
FY2027E Revenue	\$478M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.90
Fwd P/E	39.1x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$325.00	\$310.00	\$290.00
6 Months	\$360.00	\$330.00	\$275.00
1 Year	\$390.00	\$340.00	\$260.00
2 Years	\$450.00	\$375.00	\$240.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$450.00	\$220.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$600.00	\$250.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+1.56%) and Consumer Discretionary (+7% over 5 days) — Materials is the tariff/reshoring beneficiary trade, and Discretionary is signaling the consumer is still spending, which is bullish for iPhone upgrades.

COOLING OFF: Communications Services barely moved (+0.04%) — the Alphabet/Meta cohort is digesting the AI capex concerns, which is Apple-adjacent noise.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing into cyclicals (Materials, Industrials, Discretionary) on Iran deal hopes and record highs — that's a "risk-on" rotation that usually pulls mega-cap tech like AAPL along for the ride, but with a lag.

RELATED PLAY: Memory chip names (Micron, SK Hynix) are the direct beneficiaries of Apple's supplier commitment jump — the Motley Fool piece called this out. If you believe the iPhone ramp story, memory stocks give you leveraged exposure.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MU (Micron): Direct beneficiary of Apple's memory purchase ramp — memory pricing power is returning.
- AVGO (Broadcom): Apple's key RF/wireless chip supplier — same iPhone ramp thesis, higher beta.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is lagging its supplier ecosystem right now, which is unusual — normally Apple leads and suppliers follow. That gap tends to close, and historically it closes with Apple catching up rather than suppliers falling. That's a bullish tell.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — Fundamentals are quietly strengthening while the stock is being punished for headline noise. That's usually a good setup, but the CEO transition adds real uncertainty I can't hand-wave away.

POSITION SIZE: 5-8% — this is a core holding for most portfolios; the balance sheet and buyback machine give you a floor most stocks don't have.

ENTRY POINTS: \$300-305 range on any macro fear day. If it breaks \$295 on succession news, that's the "back up the truck" level assuming no fundamental damage.

TIME HORIZON: 12-18 months — you're waiting for the iPhone cycle to show up in reported numbers (2-3 quarters out) and for the new CEO to establish credibility.

WHEN TO BAIL: If iPhone unit sales miss by 8%+ next quarter, or if China tariffs escalate to 25%+ on electronics, or if the new CEO is a wildcard the market doesn't trust.

HEDGING: Buy \$290 puts expiring in 3 months as insurance — costs a little, but caps your downside if the CEO announcement lands badly. Or just keep 20% of your intended position in cash and add on dips.

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$161.55 ▼ 0.68%	12M Price Target \$175.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$387.29B
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PLTR: Blowout Q2 Crushes Shorts, But Valuation Screaming

WHAT HAPPENED

- PLTR ripped ~30% from Friday to Monday (roughly \$125 → \$162) after Q2 earnings absolutely crushed it — commercial revenue growth blew past expectations, and management raised guidance again. Today it's cooling off a tiny bit (-0.7%) which is normal digestion after a monster move.
- The short squeeze got vicious — shorts lost about \$3 billion in a day. That tells you positioning was heavily bearish going in, and now those forced-buyers are out of ammo, meaning the next leg needs real buyers, not covering.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what this move really means: Palantir isn't just beating numbers, it's proving the thesis that AI spending in both government AND the private sector is accelerating, not slowing down. The commercial business — which was the big question mark for years — is now growing fast enough that PLTR is no longer just a "government contractor with a cool story." That said, when a stock jumps 30% in a day, most of the good news is now in the price — watch for the "sell the news" fade over the next 2-3 weeks as fast money takes profits. The bigger picture: the Trump administration's push for AI dominance and the ongoing DoD modernization budget means PLTR's federal pipeline has years of runway, but at \$387B market cap, you're paying for that runway upfront.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The tailwind is enormous: the FY2026 defense budget includes major increases for AI/software modernization (JWCC, Maven, TITAN programs) — PLTR is a prime beneficiary and already embedded in most of these. Also watch the ongoing debate over federal AI procurement rules — the administration has been pushing to streamline software buying, which favors incumbents like PLTR over legacy defense primes. Risk on the horizon: if Democrats retake the House in the midterms, expect scrutiny on Palantir's ICE and immigration contracts — that's headline risk but historically hasn't dented the stock.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

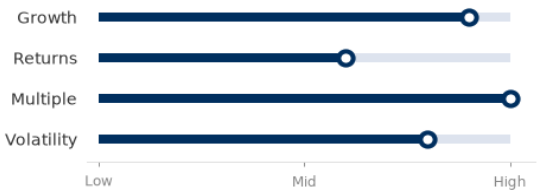
This is where I have to be honest — the stock trades at roughly 80x forward revenue, meaning investors are paying \$80 for every \$1 of sales the company will generate next year. Peers like Snowflake and CrowdStrike trade at \$15-20 per dollar of revenue. That's not "expensive," that's "priced for a miracle." The only way to justify it is if you believe PLTR compounds revenue at 40%+ for 5 straight years — possible, but there's zero margin for error.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$161.55
12M Price Target	\$175.00
Upside / (Downside)	+8.3%
Market Cap	\$387.29B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,850M
FY2027E Revenue	\$6,400M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.72
FY2027E EPS	\$0.98
Fwd P/E	224.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$180.00	\$165.00	\$140.00
6 Months	\$210.00	\$175.00	\$130.00
1 Year	\$240.00	\$185.00	\$120.00
2 Years	\$300.00	\$220.00	\$110.00
5 Years	\$450.00	\$300.00	\$130.00
10 Years	\$700.00	\$425.00	\$150.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+1.56%) and Industrials benefiting from infrastructure spending momentum; Consumer Discretionary up 7% over 5 days signals risk-on mood which helps high-multiple names like PLTR.

COOLING OFF: Nothing dramatically weak today, but Comm Services is barely moving — the mega-cap tech leadership is narrowing, which is a yellow flag long-term.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is chasing AI winners with real earnings (PLTR, NVDA) rather than speculative AI stories — that's a "quality" rotation and it favors PLTR near-term but means any earnings stumble gets punished harder.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the AI-for-government thesis but want cheaper exposure, look at defense primes leaning into software (BAH, LDOS) or data center infrastructure (VRT, ETN) that benefits regardless of which AI company wins.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the picks-and-shovels AI leader — every PLTR deployment ultimately runs on NVDA chips.
- ANET (Arista Networks): AI data center networking, riding the same federal + enterprise AI capex wave.

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR is LEADING its peer group hard after this print — it's now the AI software bellwether alongside NVDA. But leadership at extreme valuations tends to attract selling pressure on any market wobble. The setup rhymes with 2000 Cisco — dominant, deserved, but priced for outcomes that are hard to deliver.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — Great business, questionable entry point. I love the company, I don't love the price tag after a 30% one-day move.

POSITION SIZE: 2-3% of portfolio — small enough that a 40% drawdown doesn't wreck you, big enough to matter if it doubles.

ENTRY POINTS: Don't chase here. Wait for a pullback to \$135-145 (which happens 1-2x per year on macro fear or a merely-good earnings quarter).

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst is continued federal AI budget growth and commercial customer count doubling.

WHEN TO BAIL: Two straight quarters of commercial growth below 35%, or a major federal contract loss, or if Karp signals he's stepping back.

HEDGING: Simplest approach — trim 25% of your position after big rips like this one and rebuild on dips. If you want insurance, buy 6-month puts 15% below current price; costs a bit but sleeps well.

Amazon.com, Inc.
AMZN NASDAQ

Buy	\$277.51 ▲ 0.03%	12M Price Target \$320.00	52-Week Range \$196.00 – \$287.20	Market Cap \$2.99T
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AMZN: Perplexity Loss Stings, But AI Story Still Cooking

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is basically flat today (\$277.51, +0.03%) but sitting at 89% of its 52-week range after a monster earnings-week rally (jumped from \$235 to \$284 in three sessions). Translation: the market already re-rated this thing higher on earnings — now it's digesting.
- Two competing headlines: (1) Andy Jassy said something bullish about AI adoption that Motley Fool is hyping, and (2) the 9th Circuit just overturned Amazon's injunction against Perplexity AI — meaning Perplexity's AI browser agents can keep scraping/shopping on Amazon. That's a real negative for Amazon's control over its retail moat.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Perplexity ruling matters more than people realize — it basically says AI agents that shop on your behalf are legal, and Amazon can't block them. Short-term that's fine, but long-term it means the "front door" of e-commerce could shift from Amazon.com to whichever AI assistant you use, and Amazon becomes plumbing rather than the destination. Counterbalancing that: Jassy's AI commentary suggests AWS is seeing the AI capex wave translate into actual revenue, which is the single biggest bull case here. Net-net, the stock is pausing because the market is weighing "AWS is accelerating" against "our retail moat just got legally punctured" — and honestly, AWS is bigger for the stock price than retail is.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Three things on the radar: (1) The FTC's antitrust case against Amazon's retail practices is still grinding through courts — a loss could force behavioral remedies on Prime bundling. (2) AI regulation: the administration has been generally pro-AI-buildout (good for AWS), but there's bipartisan chatter about "AI agent liability" frameworks — the Perplexity ruling will accelerate that debate. (3) Tariffs on Chinese goods remain a live issue for Amazon's third-party marketplace, where a big chunk of sellers source from China — any escalation squeezes seller margins and eventually Amazon's take rate.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~\$2.99T market cap and roughly 40x forward earnings, you're paying \$40 for every \$1 of next year's profit — that's a premium, but AWS alone probably justifies half the market cap and it's growing 19%+ with expanding margins. Compared to Microsoft (~32x) and Google (~22x), Amazon looks pricier, but it has the fastest-growing high-margin business of the three right now. Fair, not cheap — you're buying quality, not a bargain.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-05 14:47 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$277.51
12M Price Target	\$320.00
Upside / (Downside)	+15.3%
Market Cap	\$2.99T
FY2026E Revenue	\$745M
FY2027E Revenue	\$820M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.85
FY2027E EPS	\$7.90
Fwd P/E	40.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$295.00	\$282.00	\$260.00
6 Months	\$320.00	\$295.00	\$250.00
1 Year	\$345.00	\$320.00	\$240.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$355.00	\$230.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$450.00	\$220.00
10 Years	\$850.00	\$650.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Discretionary (+7% over 5 days) — this is where Amazon lives, and the sector move suggests money is betting on a resilient consumer plus AI-driven productivity gains. Industrials (+6% 5-day) also ripping, which usually means capex/infrastructure themes are in favor — good for AWS.

COOLING OFF: Healthcare is choppy (-1.3% over 5 days) and Comm Services is barely moving — investors are rotating OUT of defensives and INTO growth/cyclicals.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing into anything AI-infrastructure-adjacent, which is why AMZN went from \$235 to \$284 in three days. The rotation looks like: out of bonds/defensives, into AI + consumer cyclicals.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI agent thesis from the Perplexity ruling, the winners are the pick-and-shovel names — data center REITs (DLR, EQIX) and semiconductor infrastructure. If Amazon's retail moat weakens, Shopify (SHOP) is the second-order winner because independent merchants become more valuable to AI agents.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Same AWS/Azure AI infrastructure tailwind, arguably better positioned on enterprise AI adoption.
- GOOGL (Alphabet): AI search transition risk is real but they own the front-end that AI agents may live inside.

AMZN CONTEXT: AMZN is leading its peer group right now — the 20% pop in a week suggests it was the "catch-up trade" among Mag 7 names after lagging earlier in 2026. That kind of ripping move usually needs a digestion period, which is exactly what today's flat tape looks like. Not a reason to sell, but I wouldn't chase here — wait for a pullback.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 5-8% of portfolio (core holding)

Entry Points: \$265-275 on macro pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: AWS growth drops below 15% or FTC forces structural retail/cloud separation

Hedging: Small put position 5% out-of-the-money, or pair with a short in a pricier cloud peer

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Hold	\$115.01 ▼ 8.23%	12M Price Target \$135.00	52-Week Range \$104.83 – \$225.64	Market Cap \$1.52T
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SPCX: Space ETF Craters as SpaceX Earnings Disappoint

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX got smoked -8.2% today, and it's not mysterious — SpaceX (the ETF's whale holding) just posted its first earnings as a public company and Wall Street wasn't impressed. The concern is AI/Starlink capex — meaning SpaceX is spending huge sums to build out satellite internet and AI infrastructure, but investors want to see the payoff sooner.
- Notice the whipsaw: +9.4% Monday on earnings anticipation, then -8.2% Tuesday when the numbers landed. That "buy the rumor, sell the news" pattern tells you the stock was priced for perfection and didn't get it.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the thing — SPCX is trading at just 8% of its 52-week range (\$104-\$225), meaning it's near the lows. That's either a screaming buy signal or a warning that the space trade is unwinding. The options market is leaning bullish (put/call ratio 0.76, with unusual call buying at \$110-\$115 strikes) — smart money is betting this is a dip, not a collapse. But institutional ownership at just 2.2% is a yellow flag: the big pension funds and mutual funds aren't backing this up yet, which means the stock trades more on retail sentiment and can swing hard both ways.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big political tailwind here is the Trump administration's Golden Dome missile defense initiative and the expanded Space Force budget — both directly benefit SPCX holdings like Rocket Lab, Iridium, and defense-space contractors. Watch the FY2027 defense appropriations bill working through Congress right now: if the space allocation stays north of \$30B, SPCX has a floor. The wildcard is FCC spectrum policy — any ruling that favors terrestrial 5G over satellite broadband (Starlink, Iridium) would hurt this ETF disproportionately since satellite comms is ~40% of the basket.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

SPCX isn't valued like a normal stock — it's an ETF, so you're paying for the underlying basket. Right now the basket is heavily weighted to SpaceX post-IPO, and SpaceX is trading at roughly 15x sales — meaning investors pay \$15 for every \$1 of revenue, which is rich but defensible if Starlink hits profitability. The ETF looks reasonable here versus its highs, but "cheap" depends entirely on whether SpaceX delivers next quarter — you're really making a bet on one company.

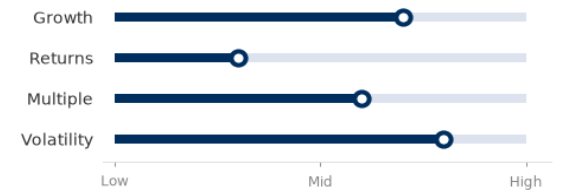
WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- SpaceX concentration risk — if SpaceX has another rough quarter, this ETF drops 10%+ again regardless of what other holdings do. It's not really diversified anymore.

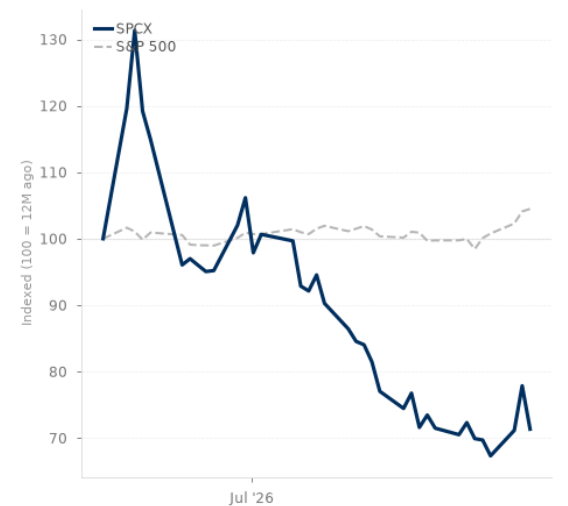
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$115.01
12M Price Target	\$135.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.4%
Market Cap	\$1.52T
FY2026E Revenue	—
FY2027E Revenue	—
FY2026E EPS	N/M
FY2027E EPS	N/M
Fwd P/E	N/M

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$128.00	\$118.00	\$105.00
6 Months	\$155.00	\$130.00	\$100.00
1 Year	\$180.00	\$135.00	\$95.00
2 Years	\$220.00	\$160.00	\$90.00
5 Years	\$300.00	\$200.00	\$80.00
10 Years	\$500.00	\$300.00	\$70.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+1.56%) and Industrials (+6% over 5 days) — both benefiting from infrastructure spending and the Hormuz deal chatter reducing supply chain fear. Consumer Discretionary (+7% 5D) shows risk-on appetite is alive.

COOLING OFF: Space/defense sub-sector today, but that's SpaceX-specific noise, not a broad sector rejection. Healthcare had a rough 5-day stretch (-1.31%) despite today's bounce.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is moving into cyclicals and industrials on trade optimism (Trump/Hormuz), which historically pulls capital OUT of speculative growth names like space. That's a near-term headwind for SPCX.

RELATED PLAY: If space is your thesis but you want less SpaceX concentration, look at Rocket Lab (RKLB) directly, or defense primes like Lockheed (LMT) and Northrop (NOC) which have big space divisions and pay dividends.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- LMT (Lockheed Martin): Winning because defense budget certainty + space systems division growth — less binary than SPCX.
- RKLB (Rocket Lab): The pure-play alternative that benefits when SpaceX stumbles, since customers seek launch diversification.

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is LAGGING its underlying components because SpaceX is dragging the whole basket down. That's actually a setup — if you believe SpaceX bounces, SPCX gives you leveraged exposure to that rebound without single-stock risk.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — cautiously constructive; the long-term space thesis is intact but near-term is messy while SpaceX finds its footing as a public company.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% — this is volatile and concentrated, so don't oversize. Treat it like a thematic bet, not a core holding.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd start scaling in around \$108-112 (near the 52-week low) and add more if it touches \$105. Don't chase above \$125.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — you need at least 2-3 more SpaceX earnings prints to see if Starlink profitability is real.

WHEN TO BAIL: If SpaceX misses on Starlink subscribers next quarter, or if the defense space budget gets cut by more than 15% in reconciliation, take the loss and move on.

HEDGING: Buy a little QQQ (broad tech) alongside it — if the whole growth trade rolls over, you're not just holding one narrow bet. Or just keep some cash on the side to average down.

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Hold	\$93.95 ▲ 0.47%	12M Price Target \$95.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$84.47B
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HOOD: Rally Extends, But Valuation Getting Stretched Here

WHAT HAPPENED

- HOOD is up ~8% in two days and just under \$94 — the catalyst is the Y Combinator startup fund news. In plain English: Robinhood is letting regular people invest in early-stage startups (something previously reserved for millionaires and VCs). That's a huge product expansion — new revenue stream, stickier users, and it plays right into the "democratize finance" brand.
- The Bloomberg piece about young men day-trading and feeling like failures is a yellow flag hidden in the noise — HOOD's core user is exactly that demo, and if engagement burns out or regulators pounce on "gamification," it hits the model.

WHY IT MATTERS

The YC fund launch is bigger than it looks — Robinhood is quietly turning itself into a full-stack wealth platform (stocks, crypto, retirement, now private markets), which means the market can start valuing it like a fintech ecosystem rather than a trading app. That's how you justify a premium multiple. But here's the tension: the stock has already ripped from \$63 to \$94 (up 48% off the lows) and today's volume is anemic (~4.5M shares vs. 20M+ typical) — meaning this last leg up is thin and could easily give back on any bad print. The options flow is screaming bullish (put/call at 0.39, meaning traders are buying 2.5 calls for every put), but a lot of that is chasing — not conviction.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The regulatory backdrop for HOOD is the friendliest it's been in years — the current administration has pushed crypto-friendly rules (the GENIUS Act framework on stablecoins passed last year), and the SEC under new leadership has backed off the aggressive enforcement posture that hammered HOOD in 2022-2024. Watch for movement on the SEC's "accredited investor" rule reform — if they lower the wealth threshold to let more retail into private markets, that YC fund product goes from novelty to massive revenue driver. Downside watch: any renewed push in Congress on "payment for order flow" (how HOOD makes money routing your trades to market makers) — it's been quiet but Elizabeth Warren has floated bills before, and that's ~40% of transaction revenue.

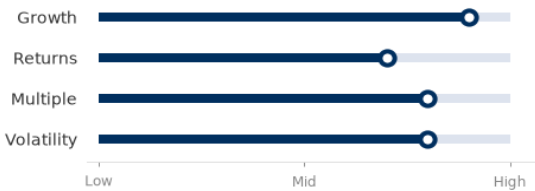
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$84B market cap and ~50x forward earnings, you're paying \$50 for every \$1 of profit — that's roughly 2x what Schwab or Interactive Brokers trade at. The bull case says HOOD deserves it because revenue is growing 40%+ vs. single digits at legacy brokers, and the crypto/private markets optionality is real. But at 34% of the 52-week range and near recent highs, you're no longer buying the dip — you're buying momentum, and that's a different risk profile.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$93.95
12M Price Target	\$95.00
Upside / (Downside)	+1.1%
Market Cap	\$84.47B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,300M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.40
Fwd P/E	50.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



HOOD — Robinhood Markets, Inc. | August 05, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$105.00	\$95.00	\$82.00
6 Months	\$130.00	\$100.00	\$75.00
1 Year	\$155.00	\$110.00	\$70.00
2 Years	\$200.00	\$135.00	\$65.00
5 Years	\$300.00	\$180.00	\$55.00
10 Years	\$500.00	\$250.00	\$40.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+1.56%) and Consumer Discretionary (+7% over 5 days) — signals a risk-on environment where retail is spending and speculating, which directly helps HOOD's trading volumes.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services is flat and Healthcare had a rough week — money is leaving defensive names.

ROTATION WATCH: Capital is rotating into cyclical and financials (+2.7% this week) — that's a tailwind for HOOD because it correlates with retail engagement and rising markets. When the S&P is grinding up, HOOD volumes go up.

RELATED PLAY: If retail trading stays hot, look at Coinbase (COIN) as the crypto-pure version of this trade, and Interactive Brokers (IBKR) as the "boring" version that also benefits from higher trading activity without the crypto beta.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- COIN (Coinbase): Riding the same crypto-friendly regulatory wave — direct HOOD peer on the crypto side
- SCHW (Charles Schwab): Fidelity hitting \$20T in assets (per Barron's today) tells you the whole retail brokerage complex is booming — rising tide

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is leading the peer group on % gains off the lows but lagging on absolute scale — it's the high-beta way to play this theme. If you believe the retail-trading boom continues, HOOD outperforms; if it fades, HOOD gets hit hardest.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the business and the policy backdrop, but the stock has run too far too fast to pound the table here.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% — real upside but real volatility; this isn't a widow-and-orphan stock.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for a pullback to \$80-85 (which is where the pre-rally consolidation was). Chasing at \$94 gets you shaken out on the first bad tape day.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst is the private markets/YC fund product scaling plus continued crypto tailwinds through 2027.

WHEN TO BAIL: If PFOF regulation resurfaces seriously in Congress, if crypto revenue drops more than 30% quarter-over-quarter, or if the stock breaks \$75 on volume.

HEDGING: Easiest hedge is just trimming — if you own it and it hits \$105, sell 25%. If you want to get fancy, buy 3-month puts at \$85 — costs you a little insurance premium but caps your downside if this thing rolls over.

Meta Platforms, Inc.
META NASDAQ

Hold	\$591.71 ▲ 0.64%	12M Price Target \$640.00	52-Week Range \$520.26 – \$796.25	Market Cap \$1.51T
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META: AI CapEx Anxiety Meets Rebound — Range-Bound

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is stabilizing around \$591 after a violent ride — it cratered to \$539 last week on earnings (free cash flow fell 91% because Zuck is spending like crazy on AI data centers), then snapped back 10% as buyers stepped in. Today's tiny move on very light volume (3.4M shares vs. typical 25M+) tells me the panic sellers are done and we're in "wait and see" mode.
- The bigger story is the market-wide "AI CapEx" freak-out — Yahoo literally ran a segment today asking if big tech is overspending. Arista Networks ripping on earnings ("AI demand is real") is a counter-signal that helps META's bull case.

WHY IT MATTERS

Nothing major happened overnight — the thesis is intact. Keep an eye on price action and how the sector is moving for a potential entry point.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

See key data table.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- AI CapEx keeps expanding — if Zuck announces another \$20B in data center spending next quarter, the stock gets punished again regardless of ad revenue strength.
- FTC antitrust ruling — if the judge orders Instagram divestiture, the stock could drop 20%+ overnight; this is a known unknown hanging over every long position.
- The non-obvious risk: TikTok. If the US-China deal on TikTok's US operations falls apart and TikTok gets banned, META wins huge (Reels captures the users); if TikTok gets sold to a well-funded American buyer, META loses a tailwind it's been quietly enjoying for two years.

IN THE NEWS

Tech stocks today: SpaceX, AMD top quarterly results, but fail to impress Wall Street. Sha... Yahoo Finance · 2026-08-03 14:04

AI CapEx fears: Is big tech overspending? Yahoo Finance Video · 2026-08-05 10:00

Reaction to AMD Earnings Shows Why It's Hard Being in Second Place Barrons.com · 2026-08-05 14:13

Arista Networks Stock Surges as Earnings Prove AI Demand Is Real Barrons.com · 2026-08-05 13:56

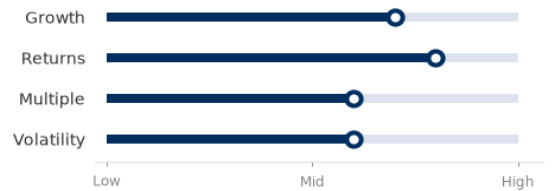
Who Might Buy Snap If Its Founders Ever Decide to Sell 24/7 Wall St. · 2026-08-05 12:25

WHAT OPTIONS TRADERS ARE DOING

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$591.71
12M Price Target	\$640.00
Upside / (Downside)	+8.2%
Market Cap	\$1.51T
FY2026E Revenue	\$195M
FY2027E Revenue	\$225M
FY2026E EPS	\$24.50
FY2027E EPS	\$28.00
Fwd P/E	24.2x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$640.00	\$600.00	\$555.00
6 Months	\$720.00	\$640.00	\$520.00
1 Year	\$800.00	\$660.00	\$480.00
2 Years	\$950.00	\$720.00	\$450.00
5 Years	\$1400.00	\$900.00	\$400.00
10 Years	\$2200.00	\$1200.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+1.56%) and Healthcare (+1.22%) — classic defensive/cyclical rotation as tech digests AI spending fears. Consumer Discretionary up 7% over 5 days signals risk-on appetite is still alive, just being more selective.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services (+0.04% today) — META's own sector is barely moving because the AI capex narrative is weighing on the whole group (Google has the same issue). This is a sector-specific headwind, not a market-wide one.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of "AI spenders" (META, GOOGL, MSFT) and INTO "AI beneficiaries" (Arista, networking, power infrastructure). That's why ANET ripped on earnings and META is stuck.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe META's AI spending will actually work, the picks-and-shovels play is buying the companies META is buying FROM — Arista (ANET) for networking, Vertiv (VRT) for data center cooling, and the utilities powering these data centers.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- ANET (Arista Networks): Ripping today because their earnings proved AI infrastructure demand is real — they sell to hyperscalers like META, so their strength is a leading indicator.
- AMD (Advanced Micro Devices): Beat on earnings but stock sank — "hard being in second place" behind Nvidia. Tells you the market is punishing anyone who isn't a clear category winner.

META CONTEXT: META is LAGGING its "Mag 7" peers over the past month because it's viewed as the biggest AI spender relative to its clear AI revenue payoff. That's actually a setup for outperformance IF they can show a single quarter of AI-driven ad revenue acceleration — the bar is now low.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — Solid business at a reasonable price, but too many binary events (FTC ruling, capex trajectory) to pound the table.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — META is a core holding for anyone with a diversified book, but I wouldn't overweight until the AI-spending narrative resolves.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$540-560 (the recent low was \$539) — that's the "AI panic" zone where the market punishes them and you get paid to be patient.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst I'm waiting for is either (a) the FTC ruling or (b) two consecutive quarters showing AI-driven ad revenue acceleration.

WHEN TO BAIL: If ad revenue growth slows below 10% YoY, or if capex guidance jumps another 25%+ without any revenue visibility, or if the FTC forces an Instagram spin-off — any of those and I'm reducing.

HEDGING: If you own META and are nervous, buy 6-month put options at the \$520 strike — think of it as insurance that pays off if the stock drops 12%+. Costs about 3-4% of your position value but lets you sleep.

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Buy	\$898.58 ▲ 0.66%	12M Price Target \$1050.00	52-Week Range \$106.75 – \$1255.00	Market Cap N/A
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MU: Memory Prices Surging, Musk Just Rang the Bell

WHAT HAPPENED

- MU bounced back hard after last week's pullback — up ~9% in two days. The big catalyst: Elon Musk publicly flagged that memory chip prices are surging, which is basically free advertising for the entire memory sector. Bank of America also doubled down on their bullish call this morning.
- Options flow is screaming bullish — traders are piling into \$900-\$920 call options (bets the stock keeps rising) at 5-8x normal volume. That's smart money positioning for more upside near-term.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the setup: AI data centers need massive amounts of a specific type of memory called HBM (high-bandwidth memory), and Micron is one of only three companies on the planet that makes it. When Musk publicly complains about memory prices, that tells you demand is way outstripping supply — which means Micron has pricing power, and pricing power in a commodity business is where fortunes get made. The CHIPS Act (bipartisan law from 2022) is literally paying Micron ~\$6B+ in federal grants to build new fabs in New York and Idaho, so Uncle Sam is subsidizing their expansion. The stock at 69% of its 52-week range suggests there's still runway before it feels stretched — especially if next quarter's earnings confirm the price surge Musk hinted at.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two big political tailwinds right now: (1) The CHIPS Act money is still flowing — Micron's Idaho fab broke ground and NY is next, with billions in federal grants plus a 25% investment tax credit that directly boosts their margins. (2) The Trump administration's tariff regime on Chinese semiconductors is actually helping Micron because their biggest competitor, China's CXMT, gets locked out of Western markets. The risk to watch: any thaw in U.S.-China trade talks could let Chinese memory suppliers back in, and separately, China has retaliated against Micron in the past by banning them from critical infrastructure — so headline risk on trade talks cuts both ways.

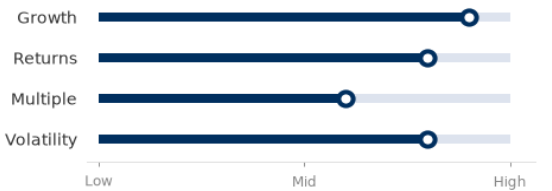
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~\$898, MU trades around 72x this year's earnings and about 48x next year's — meaning you're paying \$72 today for every \$1 they'll earn this fiscal year, dropping to \$48 as earnings grow. That's not cheap, but memory is famously cyclical (huge swings up and down), and we're early in an up-cycle driven by AI, not the usual PC/phone cycle. Compared to Nvidia at ~35x forward earnings, MU looks pricier, but Nvidia's earnings are already massive — MU's are still ramping, so the "E" in P/E is about to get much bigger.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$898.58
12M Price Target	\$1050.00
Upside / (Downside)	+16.9%
Market Cap	N/A
FY2026E Revenue	\$45,800M
FY2027E Revenue	\$58,200M
FY2026E EPS	\$12.40
FY2027E EPS	\$18.75
Fwd P/E	72.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$980.00	\$920.00	\$820.00
6 Months	\$1150.00	\$1000.00	\$780.00
1 Year	\$1350.00	\$1050.00	\$700.00
2 Years	\$1600.00	\$1200.00	\$650.00
5 Years	\$2200.00	\$1500.00	\$500.00
10 Years	\$3500.00	\$2000.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Semiconductors broadly — Marvell, SanDisk, SK Hynix all ripped yesterday. This is being driven by two things: AI infrastructure spend (still accelerating) and memory-specific pricing power. Materials is also strong (+1.56%) which often signals industrial reflation.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services is flat — the ad-driven mega-caps aren't leading anymore. Money is moving out of "safe" tech and into the picks-and-shovels of AI.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating into memory and storage names specifically — SanDisk earnings are the next catalyst, and if they confirm price hikes, it's rocket fuel for MU. This is the classic "second derivative" AI trade — you already own Nvidia, now you own what Nvidia can't function without.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the memory thesis, look at Lam Research (LRCX) or Applied Materials (AMAT) — they make the equipment Micron needs to build new fabs, so they win regardless of which memory company grabs share.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- SNDK (SanDisk): Bulls piling in ahead of earnings — same memory price tailwind as MU.
- MRVL (Marvell): Custom AI silicon story, riding the data center wave with hyperscaler contracts.

MU CONTEXT: MU is leading, not lagging — the fact that it bounced first and hardest after last week's dip tells you institutions view it as the highest-quality memory play. Compare that to SanDisk (more NAND flash, less HBM exposure) — MU has better positioning for the AI-specific memory demand.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — The setup is as clean as it gets: government subsidies, oligopoly market structure (only 3 players), and demand from the biggest capex boom in tech history. Not a 10 only because of memory's boom-bust history.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio — real upside, but memory stocks can drop 40% in a bad quarter, so don't oversize.

ENTRY POINTS: Stock pulled back to \$823 last week on nothing in particular — that kind of dip on macro fear is your add. I'd scale in at \$850 and below rather than chase \$900.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst path is: Q4 earnings (memory price confirmation) → HBM4 chip wins with Nvidia's next platform → CHIPS Act fab coming online in 2027.

WHEN TO BAIL: If HBM pricing starts rolling over on earnings calls, or if China retaliates with a formal Micron ban in a new sector, or if insider selling accelerates beyond what we saw in July.

HEDGING: Simplest way — buy a put option at \$800 for 3 months out. Costs you a little, but locks in the downside if the memory cycle turns. Or just take profits into strength above \$1,000 and let the rest ride.

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold	\$324.21 ▼ 0.96%	12M Price Target \$360.00	52-Week Range \$297.38 – \$498.83	Market Cap \$1.28T
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TSLA: AI + Energy Convergence Story Building, But Priced For Perfection

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock's down about 1% on light volume (8M shares vs the usual 35M+) — that's not real selling, that's just a quiet summer session. The bigger story: Barron's is out with a piece framing Tesla and SpaceX as "secretly merging" via AI infrastructure sharing, and Musk himself is pitching that Tesla products (think Optimus robots, Cybercab) will drive Starlink demand. Translation: he's trying to reframe TSLA as an integrated AI/energy/connectivity ecosystem, not a car company.
- The 52-week range tells you everything — stock's at just 13% of its range (\$297-\$499). It's been beaten down and is trying to base. The bullish options flow (put/call at 0.65, meaning way more call buying) suggests smart money is positioning for a bounce.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really happening: the Tesla story is being deliberately re-narrated from "EV company with softening demand" to "AI/robotics/energy platform" — and that matters because EV-only valuations are compressing across the industry while AI multiples stay rich. The capex spending theme flagged in that IBD piece is the tell — Tesla is spending massively on Dojo, data centers, and Optimus, which crushes near-term earnings but is the entry ticket to being valued like an AI company. The unusual call buying at \$325 strike expiring this month tells me traders think a catalyst is coming — probably tied to robotaxi expansion or an Optimus update. But here's the flip side: at \$1.28T market cap and ~114x forward earnings, you're paying full AI-platform prices for a company where 75%+ of revenue still comes from cars sold into a market with fading tax credits.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

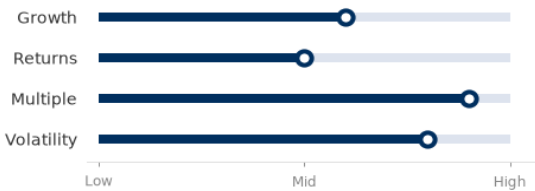
The big overhang: the EV tax credit rollback that came out of the 2025 tax package is now fully phasing in — the \$7,500 consumer credit is gone for most Tesla models as of Q3, which pressures demand right when Chinese EVs are getting cheaper globally. On the other side, the administration's push on AI infrastructure and autonomous vehicle federal preemption (overriding state-by-state robotaxi rules) is a massive tailwind if it lands — Tesla can't scale robotaxi with 50 different state regulators, so any federal framework is worth billions to them. Watch the ongoing China tariff situation too: Tesla's Shanghai Gigafactory exports to Europe, so escalating US-China trade friction can actually hurt Tesla's European margins even though they're a US company.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$324.21
12M Price Target	\$360.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.0%
Market Cap	\$1.28T
FY2026E Revenue	\$108M
FY2027E Revenue	\$128M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.85
FY2027E EPS	\$3.90
Fwd P/E	113.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$350.00	\$325.00	\$300.00
6 Months	\$420.00	\$360.00	\$275.00
1 Year	\$500.00	\$385.00	\$240.00
2 Years	\$650.00	\$450.00	\$220.00
5 Years	\$900.00	\$550.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$1500.00	\$750.00	\$150.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Discretionary is up 7% over 5 days (Tesla's home sector) and Industrials up 6% — money is flowing into cyclical growth, which usually means the market is betting on a softer landing and stronger consumer. Materials popping today suggests reflation trades are back on.

COOLING OFF: Healthcare's been weak (-1.3% over 5 days) as drug pricing pressure continues. Comm Services barely moving suggests mega-cap tech is taking a breather.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from defensive names into cyclicals and AI-adjacent industrials — that's a net positive for Tesla because it fits both buckets (consumer cyclical + AI infrastructure play).

RELATED PLAY: If the Tesla AI/energy narrative sticks, watch the picks-and-shovels names — grid infrastructure (GEV, ETN), battery materials, and data center power providers all benefit from the same trends without the single-CEO risk.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- GEV (GE Vernova): Winning on the AI power demand story — every data center Tesla and others build needs their turbines.
- RIVN (Rivian): Bouncing on VW partnership progress; catching a bid as EV sentiment stabilizes at low levels.

TSLA CONTEXT: Tesla's lagging the broader Consumer Discretionary sector (down today while XLY is up ~1%) and sitting at just 13% of its 52-week range — that's classic "the stock everyone owns but nobody loves right now." Usually when a mega-cap gets this washed out and options flow turns bullish, you get a mean-reversion bounce. The question is whether it's a tradable bounce or a durable turn — and that depends on Q3 delivery numbers.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-4% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$300-310 on macro pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Robotaxi rollout delayed past 2027 or auto gross margins fall below 15%

Hedging: Pair with a legacy automaker short or hold puts through earnings

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy	\$219.99 ▲ 3.80%	12M Price Target \$250.00	52-Week Range \$164.07 – \$236.54	Market Cap \$5.33T
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NVDA: Rips to Record as AI Capex Fears Fade

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock ripped +3.8% to a new record close, capping a 5-day, ~13% run. What's driving it: AMD and SpaceX reported earnings this week that spooked investors on their OWN stories, BUT their capex (capital spending) numbers were "shocking" to the upside — meaning the hyperscalers and AI infrastructure players are STILL spending massively on chips. Translation: NVDA's customers just told the world they're buying more GPUs, not fewer.
- Semiconductor rally is broadening — Marvell, SanDisk, SK Hynix all leading. When memory and networking chip names run alongside NVDA, that's the market pricing in a full-stack AI buildout, not just one company's story.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: the market spent July worried that "AI capex has peaked" — that Meta, Google, Amazon, Microsoft would start pulling back on GPU orders. AMD's ugly earnings reaction combined with SpaceX's report basically PROVED the opposite — spending is accelerating, not slowing. That's why NVDA is at all-time highs while a competitor stumbles: investors are concluding NVDA is taking share AND the pie is getting bigger. The options flow confirms this — 4.5 calls bought for every put, with massive unusual call buying at \$220-222.50 strikes expiring this month, meaning big money is betting on a continued melt-up into the next earnings print.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two things to watch right now: (1) Trump's reported "Hormuz deal" and broader Middle East posture matters because Saudi and UAE sovereign wealth funds have committed tens of billions to AI data centers using NVDA chips — a friendlier Gulf policy environment unlocks more of that. (2) The China export license situation remains the wild card — the administration greenlit H20 chip sales to China earlier this year, but any escalation (Taiwan, tariffs, tech transfer disputes) could yank that back. Net-net, the current regulatory setup is friendlier than it's been in 18 months, but it's one tweet away from reversing.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$220, NVDA trades around 49x forward earnings — meaning investors are paying \$49 for every \$1 the company is expected to earn next year. That sounds expensive, but they're growing revenue ~50%+ and earnings faster, so the "PEG ratio" (price relative to growth) is actually reasonable at ~1.0. Compared to AMD at ~35x earnings with slowing growth, you're paying a premium for the company that's actually executing — and history says that premium usually widens, not shrinks, when a company dominates a category this hard.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

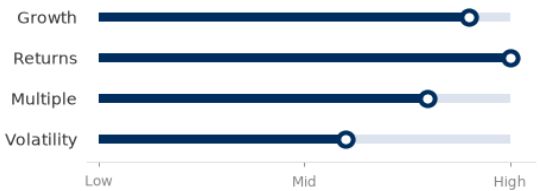
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-05 14:47 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$219.99
12M Price Target	\$250.00
Upside / (Downside)	+13.6%
Market Cap	\$5.33T
FY2026E Revenue	\$205M
FY2027E Revenue	\$265M
FY2026E EPS	\$4.45
FY2027E EPS	\$5.85
Fwd P/E	49.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$240.00	\$225.00	\$200.00
6 Months	\$270.00	\$240.00	\$185.00
1 Year	\$300.00	\$250.00	\$170.00
2 Years	\$380.00	\$300.00	\$160.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$400.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$600.00	\$200.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Semiconductors and AI infrastructure — capex commentary this week validated the buildout is accelerating, not peaking. Materials also popping (+1.56%), which often signals reflation/industrial optimism.

COOLING OFF: Healthcare is choppy (-1.3% over 5 days) as drug pricing rhetoric picks back up. Communications services is flat — the ad-driven names aren't participating in this leg.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating INTO cyclicals and semis simultaneously — that's a "risk-on, growth is fine" signal. When defensives lag and semis lead, you're in a bull tape.

RELATED PLAY: If NVDA keeps running, the picks-and-shovels behind NVDA benefit too — think power/cooling infrastructure (Vertiv, Eaton), memory (Micron, SK Hynix), and data center REITs (Equinix, Digital Realty). The AI buildout needs electricity and real estate, not just GPUs.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MRVL (Marvell): Riding the custom silicon and AI networking wave — they make the chips that connect NVDA's GPUs together in data centers.
- SNDK (SanDisk): Memory/storage rallying because AI workloads eat storage like crazy — every GPU cluster needs massive high-speed memory nearby.

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is LEADING this rally, not following — hitting new highs while AMD sells off tells you the market sees NVDA as the clear winner, not just "another chip name." That's a bullish tape signal; when the leader breaks out and peers follow, the trend has legs.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — Pounding the table but not going all-in; the setup is great but we're at all-time highs, so risk/reward isn't as juicy as it was at \$170.

POSITION SIZE: 5-8% of portfolio — Big enough to matter, small enough that a 20% drawdown doesn't wreck you. This isn't a "bet the farm" name at these levels.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for a pullback to \$205-212 to add — the stock ran 13% in a week, some cooling off is healthy. Don't chase into earnings.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst I'm waiting for is Q2 earnings late August, then Blackwell Ultra ramp commentary, then Rubin chip guidance in 2027.

WHEN TO BAIL: If data center revenue growth drops below 20% YoY, or if a major hyperscaler publicly cuts NVDA orders, or if China export policy fully reverses — any of those breaks the thesis.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy put options 10% below current price expiring 3-6 months out. Costs you a small premium but protects against a China-shock or earnings blow-up. Alternatively, trim 25% of your position if it rips another 15% from here to lock in gains.

Alphabet Inc.
GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy \$381.77 ▲ 1.09% 12M Price Target \$425.00 52-Week Range \$193.67 – \$408.61

Market Cap
\$4.67T

GOOGL: AI Spending Boom Lifts All Boats, GOOGL Leading

WHAT HAPPENED

- GOOGL is up ~14% in a week (\$333 → \$381) — that's a monster move for a \$4.7T company. The trigger: Arista Networks blew out earnings this morning proving AI infrastructure demand is real, and Blackstone is pitching a \$36B debt deal to fund Anthropic's chip buildout. Translation: every dollar of AI capex flowing through the ecosystem lands partly in GOOGL's Cloud and TPU business.
- Volume today is way lighter (5.9M vs 30-45M prior days) — meaning this is drift-up on no sellers, not fresh buying frenzy. That's actually healthier; it says the recent buyers aren't flipping.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Anthropic chip story is the real signal here — Anthropic is *hiring their own chip team* AND raising \$36B in debt for chips, which tells you the AI compute arms race is entering a new phase where model companies want vertical control. That's bullish for GOOGL because they already own that stack (TPUs + Google Cloud + Gemini), and it validates why their capex is running at \$75B+. The insider selling looks scary but it's mostly programmed 10b5-1 sales at much lower prices (\$333) — nothing to worry about. Options flow is telling: heavy call buying at \$317-350 strikes, meaning big money bought this rally on the way up and is still positioned for more.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The elephant in the room is the DOJ antitrust remedy phase — the judge ruled against Google in search last year, and the remedies decision (could force divestiture of Chrome or restrict default search deals with Apple) is the single biggest overhang. Recent signals suggest the remedy will be lighter than feared (behavioral fixes rather than breakup), which is why the stock is finally re-rating higher. Separately, the Trump administration's AI Action Plan explicitly favors US-based AI infrastructure and has loosened export controls on AI chips to allied nations — that's a direct tailwind for Google Cloud's international expansion and TPU sales.

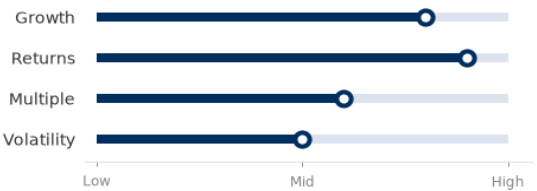
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$381, GOOGL trades around 26x forward earnings — meaning investors are paying \$26 for every \$1 of profit the company is expected to make next year. That's still a discount to Microsoft (~32x) and Meta (~28x) despite Alphabet arguably having the best AI research org on the planet. The stock's been the "cheap Mag 7 name" for two years because of antitrust fear — if that fear keeps fading, there's another 10-15% of multiple expansion available before it looks expensive.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$381.77
12M Price Target	\$425.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.3%
Market Cap	\$4.67T
FY2026E Revenue	\$405M
FY2027E Revenue	\$460M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.80
FY2027E EPS	\$11.50
Fwd P/E	26.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$405.00	\$390.00	\$360.00
6 Months	\$445.00	\$410.00	\$340.00
1 Year	\$480.00	\$425.00	\$320.00
2 Years	\$560.00	\$475.00	\$300.00
5 Years	\$750.00	\$600.00	\$350.00
10 Years	\$1100.00	\$800.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Materials (+2% 5D) and Industrials (+6% 5D) — this is the "picks and shovels" AI trade. Every data center needs copper, steel, cooling systems, and grid equipment. Consumer Discretionary (+7% 5D) is running on rate-cut hopes.

COOLING OFF: Healthcare is down 1.3% on the week — drug pricing executive order chatter is spooking pharma. Comm Services (where GOOGL lives) is only +2.4% on the week, meaning GOOGL is outrunning its own sector — that's a signal of stock-specific strength.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from pure software into "AI infrastructure enablers" — Arista's blowout confirms networking, and Blackstone's Anthropic deal confirms private credit is flooding into AI. GOOGL sits at the intersection.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI capex story, the second-order winners are utilities and nuclear names (data centers need power) and networking (ANET, VRT). Those are already running — GOOGL is the more conservative way to play the same theme.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- ANET (Arista Networks): Surged today on earnings proving AI networking demand is accelerating, not plateauing — direct read-through to Google Cloud infrastructure spend.
- AMD: Even though "results didn't impress," it's still a key beneficiary — the market is now discriminating between AI winners, and GOOGL is being sorted into the winner bucket.

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL is *leading* the mega-cap complex this week — up 14% while the broader Comm Services sector is up 2.4%. That's stock-specific alpha, driven by antitrust fear fading + AI credibility rising. Leaders in a re-rating tend to keep leading for weeks, not days, so momentum is your friend here.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$365-375 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Adverse DOJ antitrust remedy (forced Chrome/Android divestiture) or cloud growth decelerating below 25%

Hedging: Buy protective puts 10% OTM or pair with short position in a pricier AI name like a hyperscaler competitor

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Buy	\$212.99 ▼ 2.56%	12M Price Target \$245.00	52-Week Range \$61.44 – \$329.88	Market Cap \$191.17B
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MRVL: AI Custom Silicon Story Intact Despite Musk Noise

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock ripped 13% on Monday (Aug 4) then gave back 2.6% today — this is classic "buy the AI story, then digest." The catalyst was AWS CEO basically saying AI capacity is sold out through 2028, which is HUGE for Marvell because they make the custom chips (ASICs) that power AWS's Trainium AI accelerators. When Amazon says "we can't build data centers fast enough," Marvell sells more silicon.
- Today's dip is Musk-driven noise — he said something bearish about Nvidia that spooked the whole chip complex. But note the low volume (6.3M vs 33M yesterday) — this is profit-taking, not a change in thesis.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what really matters: the AWS comment is a leading indicator that hyperscaler capex (the massive spending by Amazon, Google, Microsoft on AI infrastructure) isn't peaking — it's accelerating into 2027-2028. Marvell is one of only two companies (Broadcom being the other) that designs custom AI chips for these giants, so demand visibility just got extended by 18 months. The Bloomberg headline about the US ban on Chinese optical parts is actually a subtle positive for Marvell — they make optical interconnect chips (the stuff that moves data between servers at light speed), and if Chinese competitors get locked out of hyperscaler supply chains, Marvell picks up share. The bearish options flow (that \$300 put) is likely hedging, not directional betting — someone owns a lot of stock and is buying insurance after the 13% rip.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one is the US ban on Chinese optical components — this is happening RIGHT NOW and directly benefits Marvell's optical/networking business, which is roughly a third of revenue. Also watch the CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions in Congress; the original CHIPS Act gave semiconductor companies tax credits and grants for US-based manufacturing, and any expansion would flow to Marvell's design-and-fab-in-US strategy. The wildcard is Taiwan — Marvell fabs most of its chips at TSMC in Taiwan, so any escalation in China-Taiwan tensions or new export controls is a direct risk to supply.

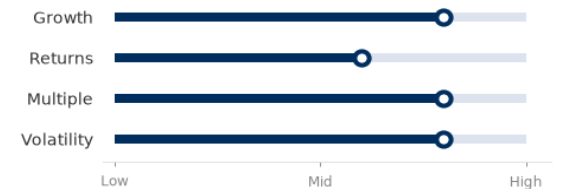
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$213, Marvell trades at roughly 75x forward earnings — meaning investors are paying \$75 for every \$1 of profit expected next year. That's expensive vs. the S&P at ~22x, but cheaper than Nvidia at ~40x on much slower growth or AMD at ~55x. The bull case is that if AI revenue hits \$8B by FY2028 (up from ~\$2B two years ago), the multiple compresses fast and the stock looks reasonable — that's the bet you're making here.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$212.99
12M Price Target	\$245.00
Upside / (Downside)	+15.0%
Market Cap	\$191.17B
FY2027E Revenue	\$8,200M
FY2028E Revenue	\$10,500M
FY2027E EPS	\$2.85
FY2028E EPS	\$4.10
Fwd P/E	74.7x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$235.00	\$215.00	\$190.00
6 Months	\$270.00	\$245.00	\$180.00
1 Year	\$320.00	\$260.00	\$170.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$300.00	\$160.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$380.00	\$140.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$500.00	\$120.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Semiconductors and AI infrastructure — the AWS "sold out through 2028" comment is essentially a green light for the entire AI supply chain. Materials also strong (+1.5%), likely tied to data center buildout demand for copper, rare earths.

COOLING OFF: Healthcare bounced today but is still down on the week — rotation out of defensives into growth. Comm Services flat suggests the ad-driven tech names aren't participating in the AI rally the same way.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing from megacap tech (post-Musk/Nvidia noise) into the "picks and shovels" AI names — Marvell, SanDisk, SK Hynix. This is smart money betting that the beneficiaries of AI capex are the component suppliers, not just Nvidia.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AWS story, the second-order plays are data center REITs (DLR, EQIX) and power infrastructure (VST, CEG) — AI data centers need 10x the electricity of regular ones.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Direct Marvell peer in custom AI silicon — benefits from same hyperscaler capex story, but larger and more diversified.
- SNDK (SanDisk): Memory/storage play, named in the same rally headline — AI training needs massive storage, and the China optical ban is boosting US suppliers broadly.

MRVL CONTEXT: Marvell is at 56% of its 52-week range, meaning it's been more volatile than peers but also has more room to run if the AI narrative holds. It's leading the rally on percentage basis but lagging AVGO on absolute market share of AI silicon revenue — that's your opportunity if you think Marvell is catching up.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 3-5% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$195-205 on AI sector pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Loss of Amazon Trainium or Google custom silicon program, or China export ban expansion to include Marvell IP

Hedging: Buy protective puts or pair with short position in a pure-play AI name at richer valuation

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc. Defense Technology	8.5/10	BUY	
Price: \$129.18 · 1M: +18.8% · P/S: 0.9x · Cap: \$16.2B			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt					
2	MSFT	Microsoft Corporation AI & Machine Learning	8.5/10	BUY	
Price: \$490.97 · 1M: +27.0% · P/S: 11.0x · Cap: \$3645.7B			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Monitor for pullback to \$555 entry					
3	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc. Semiconductors	7.7/10	BUY	
Price: \$30.64 · 1M: +12.7% · P/S: 0.6x · Cap: \$19.8B			OPT:NEUT	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt					
4	HII	Huntington Ingalls Industries Defense Technology	7.7/10	BUY	
Price: \$321.85 · 1M: +9.4% · P/S: 1.0x · Cap: \$12.7B			OPT:NEUT	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt					
5	MDB	MongoDB, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	7.7/10	WATCH	
Price: \$378.98 · 1M: +5.9% · P/S: 11.7x · Cap: \$30.5B			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Monitor for pullback to \$280 entry					